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13TH Hamilton 40 Under Forty Business Achievement Awards

40 2026 Hamilton UNDER FORTY BUSINESS ACHIEVEMENT AWARDS

2026 RECIPIENTS

Business Link Media Group

Ahmed Ashraf
BDO Canada LLP / Futuroos

Monica Carnicelli
Carriage Gate

Nicole Carter
Valley Centre for Counselling / McMaster University

Kenneth Chavez
CARSTAR Chavez Auto Group

Ariana Cirillo
Coffee Bean Media

Kyle Datzkiw
Empire Mortgage Group

Derek Decloux
Canadian Armed Forces

Adrianne DiSimoni
DiSimoni Law Professional Corporation

Ohood Elzibak
OrthoPA Network Inc.

Chris Esposto
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Andrew Fedurko
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Carmen Fidanza
Ontario Ravioli

Gregary Ford
Swim Drink Fish Canada

Dr. Chris Fraccaro
Fraccaro Dental Group

Alfonso John Frisina
AlMar Holdings

Vanessa Giansante
Nera Hair Lounge

Katelyn Gillis
Landwise

Jaclyn Halliday
Fundamental Life Services

Andrew Hazell
Hazell Mortgages

Alex Hill
RE/MAX Escarpment

Simoni Lawrence
Hamilton Sports Group

Rhianna Malcolm
Global University Systems North America

Ashlynn Marques
The Aesthetics Boutique Medical Spa

Petra Matar
Design Partners in Architecture and Interiors (DPAI)

Alexis Mercanti
Mercanti Automotive CARSTAR

Parvathy Pillai
Canadian Urban Transit Association (CUTA)

Nicolas Randazzo
University of Alberta

Mary-Frances Raso
Author

Amber Richardson
Communicate PR

Dana Rollo
ACTIIV Hair Science

Tej Sandhu
Departure Bay Consultancy / McMaster University

Jordan Seminerio
Pristine Property Care Inc.

Rhianna Simmons
Anchor Rehabilitation Support Services Inc.

Stefa Sokolowski
City of Hamilton

Calvin Star
Carmens Group

Andrew Tedeschi
LaunchLife International

Cody Vandommele
iMove Clinic

Julia Vignanello
Royal LePage Burloak Real Estate Services

Paolo Violi
TD Bank

Christopher Paul Yendt
Sheridan Student Union (SSU) / Blenham

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UNDER FORTY

KYLE DATZKIW

Mortgage Agent Level 1 - Empire Mortgage Group

LIC. #M24001442



Celebrating Kyle Datzkiw on being named one of Hamilton's 40 Under Forty.

> Leadership isn't just about building a business. It's about building **a community.**

From helping families achieve homeownership to supporting local initiatives through **Empire Cares**, Kyle leads with purpose by financing dreams and strengthening the community we all call home.

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A MESSAGE FROM BUSINESS LINK MEDIA GROUP

Celebrating Excellence

Dear 40u40 Winners,



On behalf of **Business Link Media Group**, I am honored to extend my heartfelt congratulations to the 40 outstanding business professionals being recognized tonight with the 40 Under Forty Business Achievement Awards. Along with **Charlie Agro, Co-chair of the Hamilton 40 Under Forty Committee**, we are delighted to celebrate your accomplishments and the positive impact you continue to make within our community.

The selection process for these awards is rigorous, evaluating nominees on the basis of personal growth, business achievements, and community involvement. Our distinguished panel of judges, comprised of past 40u40 awardees renowned for their integrity, meticulously reviewed each nomination to ensure that only the most deserving individuals are honored.

We are profoundly grateful to everyone who took the time to nominate these exceptional leaders. Your contributions have been pivotal in recognizing those who have truly earned this distinction.

These awards are not only a token of appreciation for the challenges you have overcome, but also a celebration of the ongoing progress you make in enriching the Hamilton community.

Once again, congratulations on this well-deserved honor. I look forward to witnessing the continued impact of your endeavors and the promising future you are building.

Marilyn Tian, MBA
President & CEO, Business Link Media Group

40 UNDER FORTY
ITINERARY

RECEPTION
5:00 PM - 6:00 PM
OPEN REMARKS & DINNER
6:00 PM - 7:45 PM
AWARDS PRESENTATION
7:45 PM - 9:00 PM
WINNERS GROUP PHOTO
9:10 PM

Business Link Media Group

MASTERS OF CEREMONIES



Brooke Hicks (2025 alumna)

Brooke Hicks leads the Brooke Hicks Team at Royal LePage, serving clients throughout the Halton region. Having surpassed a quarter of a billion dollars in career sales, she ranks among Royal LePage Canada's Top 1% of agents. Brooke is known for delivering exceptional client service, award-winning leadership, community involvement, and empowering others through mentorship and her podcast.

Vince Genuardi (2023 alumnus)

Born and raised in Hamilton, Ontario, Vince Genuardi has spent over a decade in senior living leadership, serving as a General Manager, Executive Director, and CEO.

A 2023 40 Under Forty honouree and Best in Class recipient, Vince proudly returns for his third year as Master of Ceremonies for the prestigious Hamilton 40 Under Forty event.



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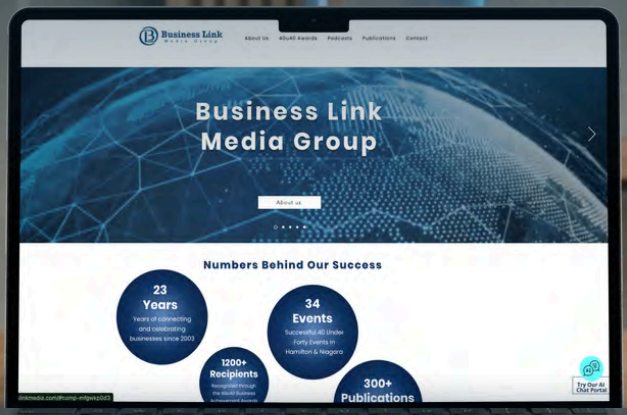
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For over two decades, Business Link Media Group has been connecting and empowering businesses through innovative marketing, digital and print publications, and award programs.

Our portfolio includes the renowned 40 Under Forty Awards programs, annual magazines like Made in Niagara and All in the Family, and customized AI marketing solutions that help brands grow smarter.

We combine storytelling, technology, and community engagement to help organizations strengthen their presence, reach new audiences, and drive meaningful results.



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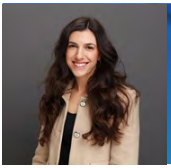
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Ahmed Ashraf

A former military officer, Ahmed Ashraf knows resilience firsthand. After overcoming paralysis, he rebuilt his life around one mission: helping others anticipate, adapt, and recover. Today he is the Crisis and Business Resilience Leader at BDO Canada LLP, where he leads the firm's national resilience practice. Over 15+ years, he has helped 100+ organizations across Canada become more resilient. He authored the book "Falling Forward" and was inducted into the Order of the Sword and Shield Honor Society. Ahmed also founded Futuroos, an AI-powered behavioral intelligence platform helping children ages five to nine be the best version of themselves.

COMPANY:
BDO Canada LLP / Futuroos



Monica Carnicelli

Monica Carnicelli is the Director of Operations at Carriage Gate. After building a strong foundation at RBC Capital Markets, she joined her family's real estate development company, which has been building in Hamilton and Burlington since 1988. Monica oversees major residential projects, guiding them from land acquisition through planning approvals, financing, sales and marketing, all the way to construction and customer care. Dedicated to shaping and advocating for the local industry, Monica also serves on the Board of Directors for the West End Home Builders' Association (WEHBA).

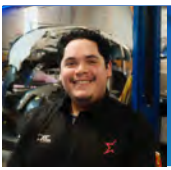
COMPANY:
Carriage Gate



Nicole Carter

Having grown up with anxiety herself, Nicole Carter has dedicated her career to helping children, adults, and families navigate anxiety and obsessive-compulsive challenges. She is an Assistant Professor at McMaster University, where she teaches in the DeGroote School of Medicine and the Master of Science in Psychotherapy program. Nikki founded Valley Centre for Counselling, a practice committed to compassionate, evidence-based care and training future therapists. She is also the author of Brave on Purpose, a children's book that brings therapy principles to life, and the creator of Worries Card Sort, an assessment game that helps children share their inner worlds through play.

COMPANY:
Valley Centre for Counselling / McMaster University



Kenneth Chavez

Kenneth Chavez is Vice President of Chavez Auto Group, overseeing four CARSTAR, one Take 5 Oil Change, and three UniglassPlus locations. With 15 years in the family business, Kenneth has grown from detailing vehicles to leading operations across the organization. Working alongside his father, he is focused on expanding and strengthening the family business for the future. Kenneth is also active in the Hamilton community through fundraising, hiring initiatives, and local sports sponsorships. He is currently pursuing his MBA to further develop his leadership and business skills and help take Chavez Auto Group to the next level.

COMPANY:
CARSTAR Chavez Auto Group



Ariana Cirillo

Ariana Cirillo is the Co-Founder, Brand Strategist and Designer behind Coffee Bean Media. With a background in branding, graphic design, photography, videography, and content strategy, she helps businesses build thoughtful, recognizable brands that feel true to who they are. Ariana holds an Honours Bachelor's Degree in Communication Studies from McMaster University, where she developed a strong understanding of how meaningful storytelling shapes perception, builds trust and creates connection. Through Coffee Bean Media, she combines creativity with strategy to help businesses communicate with purpose, strengthen their presence and stand out across every platform.

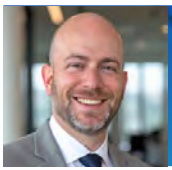
COMPANY:
Coffee Bean Media



Kyle Datzkiw

Kyle Datzkiw is a Mortgage Agent with Empire Mortgage Group who has built a growing business around relationships, trusted advice, and helping clients achieve their homeownership goals. He uses his success to support organizations, initiatives, and people he cares about. A lifelong Hamiltonian and Mohawk College graduate, Kyle believes professional success creates an opportunity and responsibility to give back. He serves as Treasurer on the Board of Directors for the Eva Rothwell Centre and dedicates significant time to mentoring Hamilton youth through coaching rep and high school basketball, as well as rep and house league flag football.

COMPANY:
Empire Mortgage Group



Derek Decloux

Dr. Derek Decloux is a dentist anaesthesiologist practicing across Southern Ontario and serving on staff at Mount Sinai Hospital in Toronto. He developed Mount Sinai's in-clinic dental anaesthesia program for patients with special needs and created the Canadian Armed Forces sedation training program for dental officers caring for military members. A Clinical Instructor at the University of Toronto and examiner for Canadian and American dental anaesthesia specialty boards, he is also a reservist Dental Officer in the Canadian Armed Forces. Dr. Decloux has been a significant fundraiser for Hamilton long-term care facilities and volunteers extensively with the Flamborough Dundas Soccer Association.

COMPANY:
Canadian Armed Forces



Adrianne DiSimoni

Adrianne DiSimoni is a criminal lawyer in Hamilton. She earned an Honours BA in Criminology from Western University (2019) and her Juris Doctor from Lakehead University's Bora Laskin Faculty of Law (2022), where she served as Managing Editor of the Lakehead Law Journal and President of the Women in Law Club. Called to the Ontario Bar in 2022, she practiced criminal defence before founding DiSimoni Law Professional Corporation in 2025. She now serves as a federal prosecutor, acting as an Agent for the Public Prosecution Service of Canada with MMLR Law, and is among the youngest serving the Hamilton-Halton region.

COMPANY:
DiSimoni Law Professional Corporation

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Ohood Elzibak

Ohood Elzibak is the founder of OrthoPA Network, an innovative healthcare hub for professional development and collaboration in orthopaedic surgery. Under her leadership, the network has grown to over 350 Physician Assistants (PAs) and health professionals. A Hamiltonian for 30 years, she graduated from McMaster's inaugural PA class. As a Palestinian and visibly Muslim woman, she has encountered barriers in healthcare and academia that have motivated her to become an advocate for justice and equity. In 2016 she received the national PA Educator of the Year award. Ohood is shaping the future of her community through entrepreneurship and leadership.

COMPANY:
OrthoPA Network Inc.



Chris Esposto

Chris Esposto is a public affairs and communications professional serving as Director of Communications and Issues Management in the Ontario government, supporting the Ministry of Children, Community and Social Services. In this role he provides strategic communications advice, manages complex issues, and helps advance government priorities through stakeholder engagement and public messaging. Chris has held progressively senior roles across multiple Ontario government ministries, spanning stakeholder relations, communications, operations, and caucus relations. He holds an Honours BA in Political Science with a minor in Social Economics from Brock University.

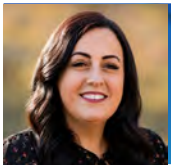
COMPANY:
Government of Ontario – Ministry of Children, Community and Social Services



Andrew Fedurko

Andrew Fedurko is a Program Coordinator and Professor at Mohawk College, where he created the Esports Administration program, recognized by Maclean's among Canada's top college programs for today's careers. Holding a Doctor of Business Administration, three master's degrees, and the internationally recognized New Product Development Professional (NPDP) certification, Andrew has taught and led initiatives across multiple Canadian post-secondary institutions. An educator, researcher, strategic consultant, and author of an upcoming Canadian leadership textbook, he builds partnerships that advance innovation and meaningful opportunities for Hamilton community.

COMPANY:
Mohawk College



Carmen Fidanza

Carmen Fidanza is the Human Resources and Retail Operations Manager at Ontario Ravioli, where she helps carry forward a family legacy built on Italian tradition, craftsmanship, and quality. With five generations of pasta-making heritage behind the business, Carmen supports its continued growth through its people, retail operations, and customer experience. Her leadership extends beyond Ontario Ravioli: she is an active contributor to the business community and serves as Vice President of the Canadian Italian Business Professional Association. Family is at the heart of what Carmen does, and she leads with the values that shaped the generations before her: hard work, integrity, and community.

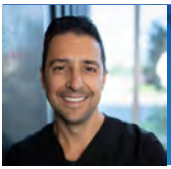
COMPANY:
Ontario Ravioli



Gregary Ford

Gregary Ford is the Vice President and Lake Ontario Waterkeeper at Swim Drink Fish Canada and the Founder of Niagara Coastal. Grounded in the guiding principle that connection to our waters leads to their protection, Gregary's work bridges the gaps between recreation, industry, and environmental conservation. His efforts have connected over 10 million people with critical information about the health of their waters, inspiring thousands to take action in protecting the waters they love. As a resident of Dundas, Ontario, his dream is to see the Hamilton Harbour swimmable, drinkable, and fishable. He can often be found walking on the beach.

COMPANY:
Swim Drink Fish Canada



Dr. Chris Fraccaro

Christopher Fraccaro is lead Dentist and Clinical Director at Fraccaro Dental Group, a family-owned and operated organization serving Greater Hamilton, Stoney Creek, and Binbrook for over 40 years. He has helped drive the expansion of three growing clinics that now employ more than 75 people and care for thousands of patients across the region. Christopher brings an entrepreneurial approach to healthcare, focused on building high-performing teams, creating sustainable growth, and delivering an exceptional patient experience. His leadership reflects a commitment to growing a strong local business while creating meaningful careers and lasting impact within the communities Fraccaro Dental Group serves.

COMPANY:
Fraccaro Dental Group



Alfonso John Frisina

Alfonso Frisina is a Hamilton entrepreneur and business owner whose work spans real estate, construction and retail. Through AlMar Holdings, he oversees land, rental property and business investments. He operates Kataract Contracting, his contracting business, and Frisina Build, which focuses on custom homes and selects commercial projects while drawing on his family's longstanding connection to homebuilding. Alfonso's broader business experience includes leadership at Harper's Garden Centre, a Hamilton institution serving the community for more than 75 years. His work is grounded in craftsmanship, long-term value and a commitment to strengthening local businesses and neighborhoods.

COMPANY:
AlMar Holdings



Vanessa Giansante

Vanessa Giansante has been in the hair industry for 20 years, earning her full hairstyling license at just 19. After 16 years building her expertise in a busy mall salon, she rented her own chair before opening Nera Hair Lounge in October 2024. Vanessa specializes in blonding and enjoys creating customized colour services for every client. A proud four-time Readers' Choice Award winner, she is passionate about ongoing education, regularly attending courses to stay current with the latest techniques and trends. Looking ahead, she is excited to keep growing her business and plans to expand Nera Hair Lounge in the future.

COMPANY:
Nera Hair Lounge

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Katelyn Gillis

A born-and-raised Hamiltonian, Katelyn Gillis has been part of Landwise's growth since joining the firm in 2017, contributing to complex planning and development projects across Southern Ontario. In 2025 she received the West End Home Builders' Association's Kevin McIntosh Memorial Award as Under-40 Young Professional of the Year. Katelyn is passionate about connecting people, creating opportunities, and building stronger communities. Her volunteer leadership includes the West End Home Builders' Association's Women in Industry Committee and WE Care Committee, Habitat for Humanity Hamilton, and Women Growing Resources in Development (W-GRID).

COMPANY:
Landwise



Jaclyn Halliday

Jaclyn Halliday is the Founder and Director of Fundamental Life Services, a community-based organization helping children, youth, and individuals with diverse abilities build independence, confidence, and meaningful connections. With a background in education and social services, Jaclyn created the organization to provide personalized, inclusive opportunities through life-skills development, recreation, employment preparation, social programs, sports, and community participation. Since launching in 2023, she has grown the business from supporting one individual to a growing network of personalized and group-based services.

COMPANY:
Fundamental Life Services



Andrew Hazell

Andrew Hazell is an independent Mortgage Agent with Synergy Mortgage Group, helping individuals and families across Canada navigate homeownership, investing, and real estate financing. A McMaster University graduate, Andrew began his career with Scotiabank before transitioning into mortgage underwriting and eventually building his own mortgage business. He is passionate about educating his clients, providing honest, practical advice, and building lasting client relationships. Born and raised in Hamilton, Andrew is proud to be involved in his community as a member of the Sons and Daughters of Italy and an annual sponsor of the Hamilton Brain Injury Association.

COMPANY:
Hazell Mortgages



Alex Hill

Alex Hill, Sales Representative with RE/MAX Escarpment, is a Hamilton-born real estate professional, investor and community-minded leader. A graduate of McMaster University, Alex has built a successful career through his commitment to clients, continuous growth and strong relationships. He has been recognized among the Top 1% of REALTORS® on the Hamilton-Burlington board and as a RE/MAX Canada Top 30 Under 30 recipient. Beyond his professional achievements, Alex is passionate about giving back, supporting those around him and using his experience to help others succeed. He strives to make a lasting, positive impact both within the real estate industry and throughout his community.

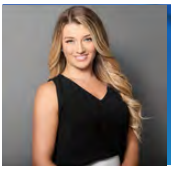
COMPANY:
RE/MAX Escarpment



Simoni Lawrence

Simoni Lawrence is a community leader, broadcaster, and former CFL athlete turning a celebrated career with the Hamilton Tiger-Cats into lasting impact. The franchise's all-time leader in defensive tackles and a multiple East Division honouree, he now serves Hamilton Sports Group in player development, brand ambassadorship, and broadcasting. He supports youth and families through Food4Kids Hamilton and the Player Academy of Excellence in Philadelphia. Drawing on personal adversity and mental health challenges, Lawrence uses mentorship, school visits, and public speaking to help others build confidence, overcome setbacks, and recognize that they do not have to face challenges alone.

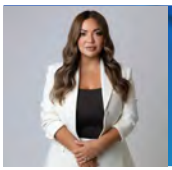
COMPANY:
Hamilton Sports Group



Rhianna Malcolm

Rhianna Malcolm is a strategic partnerships leader with over a decade of experience bringing academia, industry and government together to advance innovation and growth. As Executive Director of Strategic Partnerships at GUS North America, she leads partnerships across the organization's growing network of institutions, including supporting the launch of two new Canadian postsecondary institutions. Previously at Mitacs, Rhianna built research and innovation partnerships connecting academic researchers with industry. Her work has spanned education, life sciences, energy and workforce development.

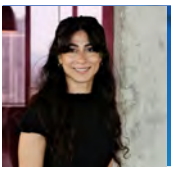
COMPANY:
Global University Systems North America



Ashlynn Marques

Ashlynn Marques is the Founder and CEO of The Aesthetics Boutique, a multiple award-winning Hamilton medical spa recognized for its uncompromising standard of care and deep community trust. A Registered Nurse with 14 years of clinical experience in emergency, intensive care, and medicine, she brings exceptional clinical expertise, state-of-the-art technology, and a personalized approach to medical aesthetics. Ashlynn launched her entrepreneurial journey from a home-based practice and, in just four years, transformed her vision into a thriving clinic recognized for clinical excellence and innovation.

COMPANY:
The Aesthetics Boutique Medical Spa



Petra Matar

Petra Matar is a Principal at Design Partners in Architecture and Interiors (DPAI), a Hamilton-based architecture, interiors, and urban design studio, and a Certified Passive House Designer with over a decade of experience leading housing, institutional, and cultural projects across Ontario. She believes in the power of design to shape communities, and brings that belief into every project, from affordable and supportive housing to civic projects and heritage adaptive reuse work. For Petra, good design is never just about buildings; it's about the people who live, work, and gather in them, and the kind of city that gets built around them.

COMPANY:
Design Partners in Architecture and Interiors (DPAI)

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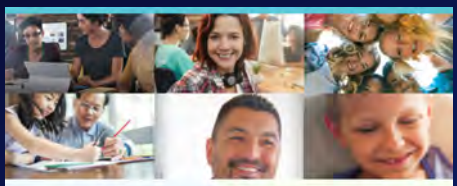
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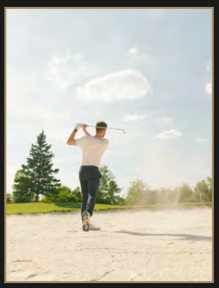
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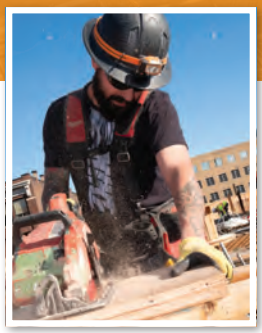
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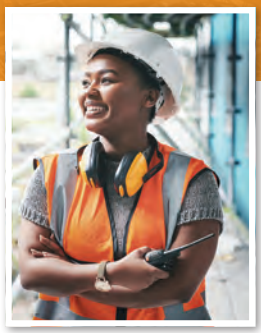


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Alexis Mercanti

Alexis Mercanti is one of the owners of Mercanti Automotive, which operates three CARSTAR Collision body shops and one Uniglass Automotive Glass shop. She officially joined the family business in September 2025, working alongside her brother, Adriano, and father, Remo. Having grown up in the collision repair industry, Alexis was inspired by exceptional role models, including her grandfather and father. She is proud to carry on her family's legacy and is committed to helping the business continue to grow while upholding the values of quality craftsmanship and exceptional customer service that have defined it for generations.

COMPANY:
Mercanti Automotive CARSTAR



Parvathy Pillai

Parvathy Pillai is Director of Research & Industry Intelligence at the Canadian Urban Transit Association (CUTA), where she leads initiatives that transform research, data, and industry intelligence into actionable insights for Canada's public transit sector. With more than 15 years of experience in infrastructure, transportation, energy transition, and business strategy, she has led nationally significant programs, advanced transportation innovation, and secured major funding initiatives. A recognized speaker, mentor, and community volunteer, Parvathy is passionate about translating research into better decisions.

COMPANY:
Canadian Urban Transit Association (CUTA)



Nicolas Randazzo

Nicolas Randazzo is a Ph.D. candidate in Earth and Environmental Sciences at McMaster University and a Sessional Lecturer/Researcher at the University of Alberta. His research focuses on sedimentology, geochemistry, and reconstructing ancient environments on Earth and other planetary bodies. Nicolas collaborates with NASA and the University of Alberta on planetary science projects, including the Mars 2020 Perseverance mission and the OSIRIS-REx Bennu sample return mission. He has authored or co-authored more than 40 peer-reviewed publications and has presented his research at conferences across North America and Europe.

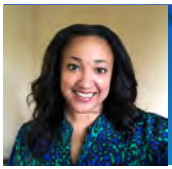
COMPANY:
University of Alberta



Mary-Frances Raso

Mary-Frances Raso is a children's author and community advocate dedicated to creating meaningful impact through literacy and inclusion. Alongside her career as a case manager supporting individuals through complex challenges, she has published two children's books that encourage kindness, empathy, and acceptance. Through countless school visits, literacy events, community markets, and fundraisers, Mary-Frances has connected with hundreds of children and families while donating book proceeds to local initiatives and charities in the community.

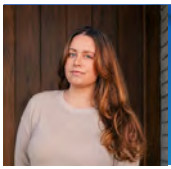
COMPANY:
Author



Amber Richardson

Amber Richardson is a strategic communications advisor, entrepreneur, philanthropist, and community leader with over 15 years of experience in public relations and corporate communications. She is the Founder of Communicate PR, where she helps organizations decide what to say, how to say it, and when it matters most. Amber is also the Founder and CEO of Achieve Professional Development Group, a nonprofit supporting entrepreneurs and professionals through education, mentorship, and meaningful connections. Deeply committed to Hamilton, she contributes her time, leadership, and expertise to initiatives that strengthen the community.

COMPANY:
Communicate PR



Dana Rollo

With over 20 years in the professional beauty industry, Dana Rollo leads Pro Education & Sales for ACTIIV Hair Science across North America, and owns a local salon in Hamilton, Ontario. Passionate about education that makes an impact, she helps stylists understand the science behind healthier hair while building confidence, increasing revenue, and delivering better results behind the chair. Known for her hair transformations and energetic, relatable teaching style, Dana specializes in turning complex concepts into practical tools that professionals can use immediately in the salon.

COMPANY:
ACTIIV Hair Science



Tej Sandhu

Tej Sandhu is the inaugural Entrepreneur in Residence at McMaster University's DeGroote School of Business and founder of Departure Bay Consultancy. His entrepreneurial journey began in music, working in Toronto and New York with some of the biggest artists in the world while helping build creative and live entertainment ventures. He later returned home to Hamilton to open MERIT Brewing, growing it into an award-winning brewery, restaurant, and retail brand before its acquisition in 2024. Tej's current role brings his path full circle, helping students, founders, artists, and creatives build the confidence and capacity to turn ideas into ventures.

COMPANY:
Departure Bay Consultancy / McMaster University



Jordan Seminerio

Jordan Seminerio founded Pristine Property Care in 2016, driven by a desire to continually challenge himself. Looking up at high-rises across Hamilton and Toronto, he knew he wanted to work on them. He earned IRATA/SPRAT Level 3 qualifications in rope access, rescue, and access systems, allowing Pristine to tackle hard-to-reach work including window cleaning, caulking, cladding, and sign installation. Today he remains hands-on throughout Hamilton and Toronto. Beyond work, Jordan advocates for men's mental health, using his career as a reminder that we can push beyond perceived limits, mentally and physically. Pristine reflects his standard: hard work and the highest quality.

COMPANY:
Pristine Property Care Inc.

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Rhianna Simmons

Rhianna Simmons is a Registered Behaviour Analyst in Ontario and a Clinical Supervisor at Anchor Rehabilitation Support Services Inc., specializing in applied behaviour analysis and the application of evidence-based behavioural supports for individuals with diverse needs. With experience supporting children, adolescents, adults, and multidisciplinary teams, she is passionate about translating behavioural science into practical, compassionate strategies that promote meaningful outcomes. Rhianna brings a collaborative, person-centred approach to clinical practice, with a focus on skill development, quality of life, and empowering caregivers.

COMPANY:
Anchor Rehabilitation Support Services Inc.



Stefa Sokolowski

Stefa Sokolowski is the Business Development and Global Hamilton Officer for the City of Hamilton, supporting business growth, economic development, and the attraction of global talent and investment. She leads the City's Soft Landing service, helping international entrepreneurs navigate the local market as they establish and grow their businesses in Hamilton. With a background in Urban Planning and a Master's in Economic Development and Innovation, Stefa is committed to fostering a strong, connected business community and creating opportunities for businesses to thrive.

COMPANY:
City of Hamilton



Calvin Star

Calvin Star joined Carmens Group in 2018 as a Mohawk College co-op student. After graduating early, he became a full-time Junior Systems Administrator in January 2019 and advanced to IT Security Manager in 2025. A self-taught security researcher, he began by uncovering vulnerabilities in systems used by the hospitality industry before expanding into IoT security and hardware hacking. His research has led to more than 30 registered CVEs and speaking engagements at BSides and DeepSec cybersecurity conferences. He currently serves on the Convention Centres of Canada Technology Committee and leads IT operations across Carmens Group venues.

COMPANY:
Carmens Group



Andrew Tedeschi

Andrew Tedeschi is a Project Manager at LaunchLife International, where he leads strategic projects and works across teams to bring new programs, partnerships, and academic initiatives from strategy through execution. A graduate of McMaster University's DeGroote School of Business, Andrew has built his career around project leadership, collaboration, and continuous improvement. He is passionate about creating meaningful impact, both through his work and within the Hamilton community. Outside of work, Andrew is actively involved with the Hamilton Steel Hockey Club, where he coaches and mentors young athletes, helping them develop on and off the ice.

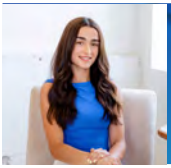
COMPANY:
LaunchLife International



Cody Vandommele

Cody Vandommele is the co-owner and lead physiotherapist of iMove Clinic, with four locations across Hamilton, Oakville and Grimsby. Passionate about patient care and professional development, Cody mentors physiotherapy students and supports the growth of the next generation of healthcare professionals. Outside of work, Cody is a proud father of three who prioritizes family time, coaching youth sports and giving back to the community. He believes in building strong teams, investing in people and creating a positive impact both within healthcare and throughout the communities he serves.

COMPANY:
iMove Clinic



Julia Vignanello

Born and raised in Stoney Creek, Julia Vignanello has called Hamilton home for over 20 years. Her lifelong passion for real estate stems from helping people through some of their largest financial decisions, which has grown into a thriving career with Royal LePage Burloak Real Estate Services, serving the Niagara, Hamilton, and GTA markets. That same dedication carries into her personal life, where she participates in community events and fundraising for Alzheimer's initiatives, a cause close to her heart and her family's. Looking ahead, Julia is excited to keep building and growing alongside the community she knows and loves.

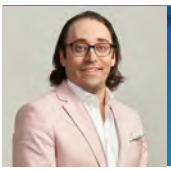
COMPANY:
Royal LePage Burloak Real Estate Services



Paolo Violi

Paolo Violi is a Personal Banker with TD Bank in Hamilton and a graduate of Brock University's Honours Bachelor of Business Administration program. He began his career with TD while completing his undergraduate degree and has since advanced through multiple roles in retail banking. Paolo is passionate about building strong client relationships, providing meaningful financial guidance, and helping individuals work toward their financial goals. A lifelong Hamilton resident, he is proud to build his career in the community that raised him and has given back through youth sports coaching, charitable initiatives, and local cultural events.

COMPANY:
TD Bank



Christopher Paul Yendt

Christopher/C. Yendt (he/they) is the Managing Director of the Sheridan Student Union (SSU) and the Principal of Blenham, a consulting firm supporting those involved in student leadership. As a PhD Candidate, their research centers the intersection of queer identities, mental health, leadership and the student experience. Their community involvement has included serving on the boards of Compass Community Health, Rainbow's End CDC, CMHA-Niagara, and St. Joseph's Healthcare Hamilton. They are a four-time graduate of Brock University, an Ontario Certified Teacher (OCT), an Ontario Association of Mental Health Professionals (OAMHP) member, and a certified director with the Institute of Corporate Directors (ICD.D).

COMPANY:
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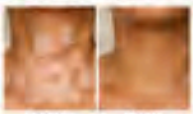
BEFORE AFTER

Scar Camouflage



BEFORE AFTER

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BEFORE AFTER

Vitiligo Camouflage



BEFORE AFTER

Stretch Mark Concealment

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Alfonso Salemi is an entrepreneur, investor, speaker, and educator who helps people and professionals create strategic pathways to growth and homeownership. As a real estate investor and lease-option strategist, he is known for practical guidance, authentic relationships, and a strong commitment to community.

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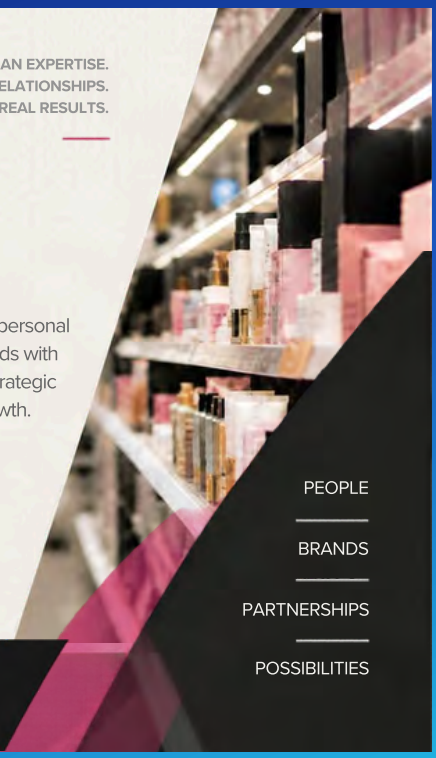
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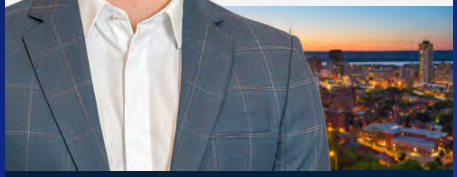
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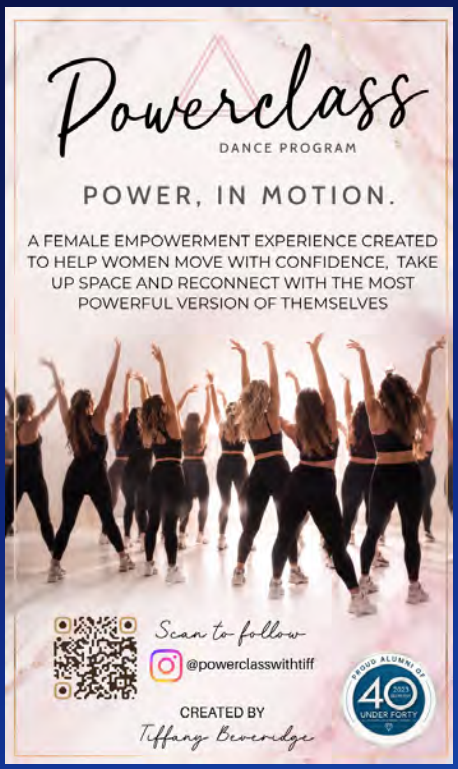
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